

Manager One on One

CONVERSATION FRAMEWORK

A one on one is not a status update. It is a dedicated space for a real conversation. Use this framework to structure 30 to 45 minutes that actually matters. The manager should speak no more than 30 percent of the time.

OPEN — 5 MINUTES

. How are you doing — genuinely?

Tip: Not a formality. Pause and actually wait for the answer.

[illegible]

. Anything on your mind before we start?

Tip: Clears the air. Sometimes the most important thing comes out here.

[illegible]

CHECK IN — 10 MINUTES

. What has gone well since we last spoke?

Tip: Start with the positive. It sets the tone and surfaces wins you might have missed.

[illegible]

. What has been difficult or frustrating?

Tip: This is where the real information lives. Do not rush past it.

[illegible]

. Is there anything blocking you right now?

Tip: Blockers left unaddressed compound. Your job is to clear the path.

[illegible]

GROWTH AND DEVELOPMENT — 10 MINUTES

. What are you learning at the moment?

Tip: If they cannot answer this, that is important information.

[illegible]

. Is there anything you want to do more of, or less of?

Tip: Surfaces job crafting opportunities and signals disengagement early.

[illegible]

. How do you feel about where you are heading?

Tip: Career direction. Growth trajectory. Sense of future. All in one question.

[illegible]

RELATIONSHIP AND SUPPORT — 10 MINUTES

. What can I do better to support you?

Tip: Ask this every time. The answers change. Be prepared to hear difficult things.

[illegible]

. Is there anything you need from me that you are not getting?

Tip: Different from the question above. More direct. Creates space for specifics.

[illegible]

CLOSE — 5 MINUTES

. What is the one thing you want to focus on before we speak next?

Tip: Ends with clarity and ownership. Write it down. Return to it next time.

[illegible]

WHAT MAKES A GOOD ONE ON ONE

- Same time, same day, every week. Consistency signals priority.
- The employee sets the agenda. You facilitate.
- No laptops. No phones. Full presence.
- Take notes. Review them before next time.
- If you cancel, reschedule the same day. Never cancel twice in a row.